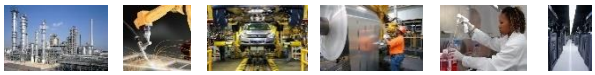
SSI Program Phases



The SSI Program has been refined to include five program phases. Each SSI Program phase is informed by proven site selection and economic development competitiveness standards and best practices. The goal is to provide a guided process of strategic site inventory development that advances only the highest quality sites with a strong consideration of site development costs. The SSI Program project phases are design to jettison less competitive sites from inventory advancement and guard against expenditure of time and dollars in pursuit of marginal sites. SSI Program phases:

- Phase I: Site Discovery
- Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence
- Phase III: Landowner Engagement
- Phase IV: Formal Due Diligence
- Phase V: Branding and Marketing

Phase I: Site Discovery is the principle differentiator between the SSI Program and site "certification" programs of various incarnations across the country. Whereas conventional site certification programs evaluate properties that are already on the marketing regardless of suitability, the SSI Program Phase I constitutes a mining exercise in which previously unknown sites of exceptional quality for industrial and commercial projects are discovered.

Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence entails a desktop engineering and environmental site review to confirm initial site development potential from Phase I discovery. The Phase II exercise is designed to expose and potential "fatal flaws" that would compromise site competitiveness. This includes a qualitative review of physical site characteristics, ecological conditions, transportation and utility connectivity, and surrounding land use compatibility along with rough-order-of-magnitude costs for site improvements and environmental permitting burden including potential wetlands mitigation.

Phase III: Landowner Engagement commences upon a site achieving a favorable development opinion from Phase II and constitutes pursuit of a real estate purchase option. Control of the subject property at a fair market value price is a requisite for site graduation to market.

Phase IV: Formal Due Diligence takes Phase II from an engineering and environmental review exercise to full "boots on the ground", quantitative site physical inspection and documentation. Phase IV is administered judiciously with only select sites qualifying as candidates for formal due diligence. Sites that merit Phase IV investment typically are suited for large-scale capital investments which require quantification of site development advantages and risks.

Phase V: Branding and Marketing is necessary to activate the SSI Program investment by creating a comprehensive informational package to globally promote the location value to target industries. Phase V should be immediately prior to the successful completion of Phase III and graduation of a site to market. Phase III resources include compelling visual documentation of the subject site along with quantifiable development advantages of both the site and the host community.

LEOTTA
LOCATION + DESIGN

Copyright @ 2014-2017 Leotta Location and Design/LEO, LLC
17170 Perkins Road, Baton Rouge, LA 70810
(225) 753-0325